designated as the chief of defence staff. Major General Shafifullah, the previous chief of the army staff who had been pro-Mujib, was replaced by Major General Ziaur Rahman. Brigadier Dastgir, commanding the 65 Brigade at Chittagong, was promoted to major general and made the commanding officer of the Bangladesh Rifles. All these officers had shown an anti-Indiabias in the past. Clearly, President Mostaq was placing people with anti-India sentiments in key positions. Mostaq followed the same policy with regard to key appointments on the civilian side. Mahbub Alam Chashi, who was appointed as the principal secretary to the president and Shafiul Azam, appointed as the new cabinet secretary, were similarly reputed to be not well disposed towards India for one reason or another. All the members of Mu-jib's cabinet were sidelined, indicating a policy to keep out those who might favour India and bring in others who were unlikely to tilt towards India. Protests against the new government were feeble. Some posters appeared in Dhaka and other cities accusing the USA's Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) of being responsible for the coup and a few underground activities by pro-Mujib activists were subdued within no time.

The officials knew Pakistan and China would exploit the changed situation in Bangladesh to the detriment of India. Pakistan was quick to grab the opportunity and recognised the new government though it had denied the same right to Mujib's government after the 1971 liberation war. Mostaq was a shrewd operator and he decided not to go overboard in accepting Pakistan's recognition and aid, fearing that it might offend India. The Pakistani authorities under Prime Minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto sensed this reluctance on Bangladesh's part and, for the time being, they gave up any flamboyant approaches to bring the two countries together. Indian intelligence officers